

IAS PRELIMS 2020

STATE BY STATE



DEMOGRAPHICAL

GEOGRAPHICAL

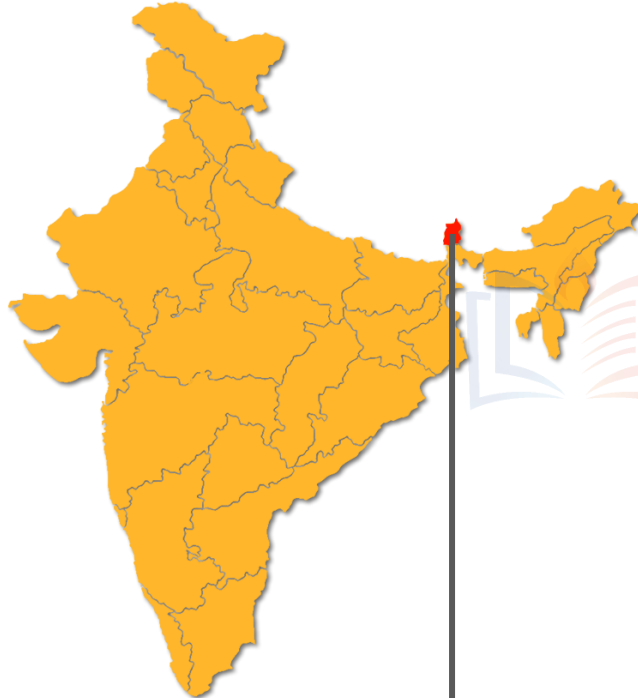
ENVIRONMENTAL

CULTURAL

MODULE - 6

1

HIGHS AND LOWS



SIKKIM

1

First and only associate state of India (35th CAA), later converted into a full-fledged state (36th CAA).

2

Article 371F – Provides special status.

3

Least populated state in India.

4

Certified as first fully organic state by the Ministry of Agriculture and Farmers' Welfare.

5

Kangchenjunga is the 2nd highest (after K2 Peak) in India (trans-border) and 3rd highest in the world.

6

Covers 0.2% geographical area of India but has 26% of total bio-diversity.

7

First state to partner with UNESCO MGIEP for implementation of SDGs in Primary Text Books.

8

Cho-Lhamu lake is the highest lake (18,000 ft) in the country and 6th highest in the world.

STATE BY STATE ... SIKKIM

1

HIGHS AND LOWS



UTTARAKHAND

IAS PRELIMS 2020

STATE BY STATE



UTTARAKHAND

DEMOGRAPHICAL
GEOGRAPHICAL
ENVIRONMENTAL
CULTURAL

MODULE - 2



Bifurcated from UP in 2000 and became 27th State at the time of formation.



One among the 10 Special Category Status states.



Nanda Devi peak is the 2nd highest peak in India.



Uttarakhand High Court declared Ganga, Yamuna as 'living persons'.



World's highest (altitude) road, the Mana Pass is in Uttarakhand.



Only state of India with Sanskrit as its Official language.



Pithoragarh and Almora are often places for military exercises.



2nd leading producer of magnesite after Tamil Nadu.

STATE BY STATE ... SIKKIM

2

BOUNDARIES



- Shares border with only one state.
- Shares international border with 3 countries.

INDIA
(TIBET)

NEPAL

BHUTAN

WEST BENGAL

GREATER HIMALAYAS

LESSER HIMALAYAS

- Lesser Himalayas comprises of most of the residential areas.
- Sivaliks are absent in Teesta valley. Sivaliks are an almost unbroken chain of low hills except for a gap which is occupied by the valley of the Teesta River and Raidak River.

TIBET
(TIBET)

NEPAL

BHUTAN

WEST BENGAL



- Singalila Range: separates Sikkim from Nepal in the west.
- Dongkya Range forms the border with the Tibet Autonomous Region of China to the east.

TIBET
(TIBET)

NEPAL

BHUTAN

WEST BENGAL



GREATER HIMALAYAS

Nathu La

Jelep La

LESSER HIMALAYAS

- Jelep La was a crucial link in the main trade route from India to Tibet until the border was closed in 1962.
- It is connected by an all-weather road via Gangtok to Darjeeling and Siliguri in West Bengal.
- There are demands to re-open Jelep La to run side by side Nathu-La.
- Menmecho Lake is below to Jelep La.

3

RELIEF FEATURES

STATE BY STATE ... SIKKIM

Manasarovar
TIBET

CHINA

Lipulekh Pass
UTTARAKHAND

ROUTE 1

ROUTE 2

N E P A L

BHUTAN

Nathu La Pass
SIKKIM

BIHAR

Two routes to reach Kailash Manasarovar:

- **Normal route:** through Lipulekh pass in Himalayas connecting Kumaon region of Uttarakhand with the old trading town of Taklakot in Tibet.
- **Nathu La route:** through Sikkim.

DRAINAGE SYSTEM A
(TIBET)

NEPAL

BHUTAN

WEST BENGAL



Rammam

Rangeet

Teesta

Ranikhola

Rangpo

Teesta

- **Teesta River:** Rises in the eastern Himalayas, flows through Sikkim and West Bengal through Bangladesh and enters the Bay of Bengal.
- **Rangeet River:** Tributary of the Teesta river

(TIBET)

NEPAL

BHUTAN

WEST BENGAL

Rangit Dam

Teesta - V Dam

Jorethang Loop

Rammam

Rangit

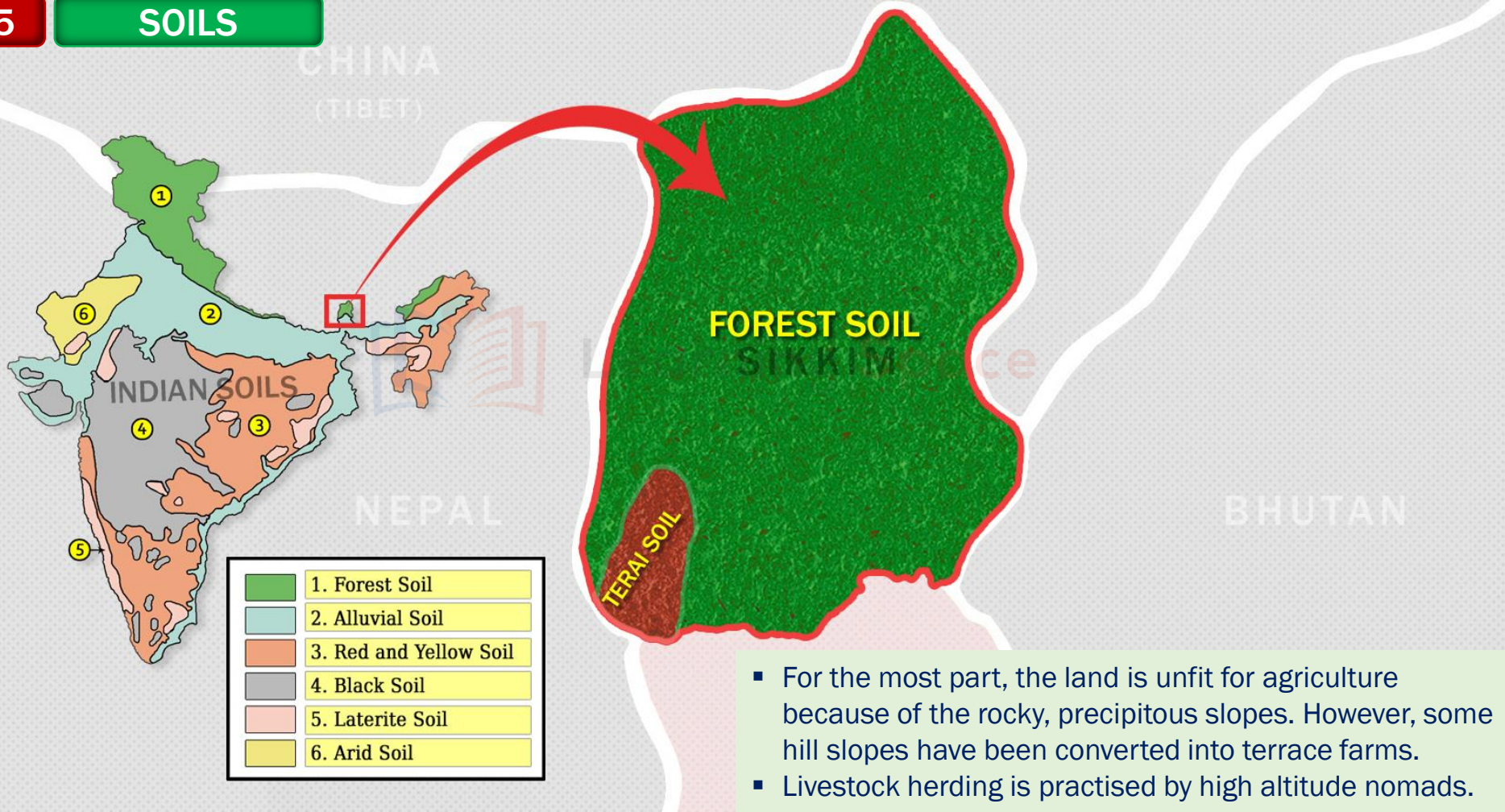
Teesta

Ranikhola

Rangpo

Teesta





STATE BY STATE ... SIKKIM



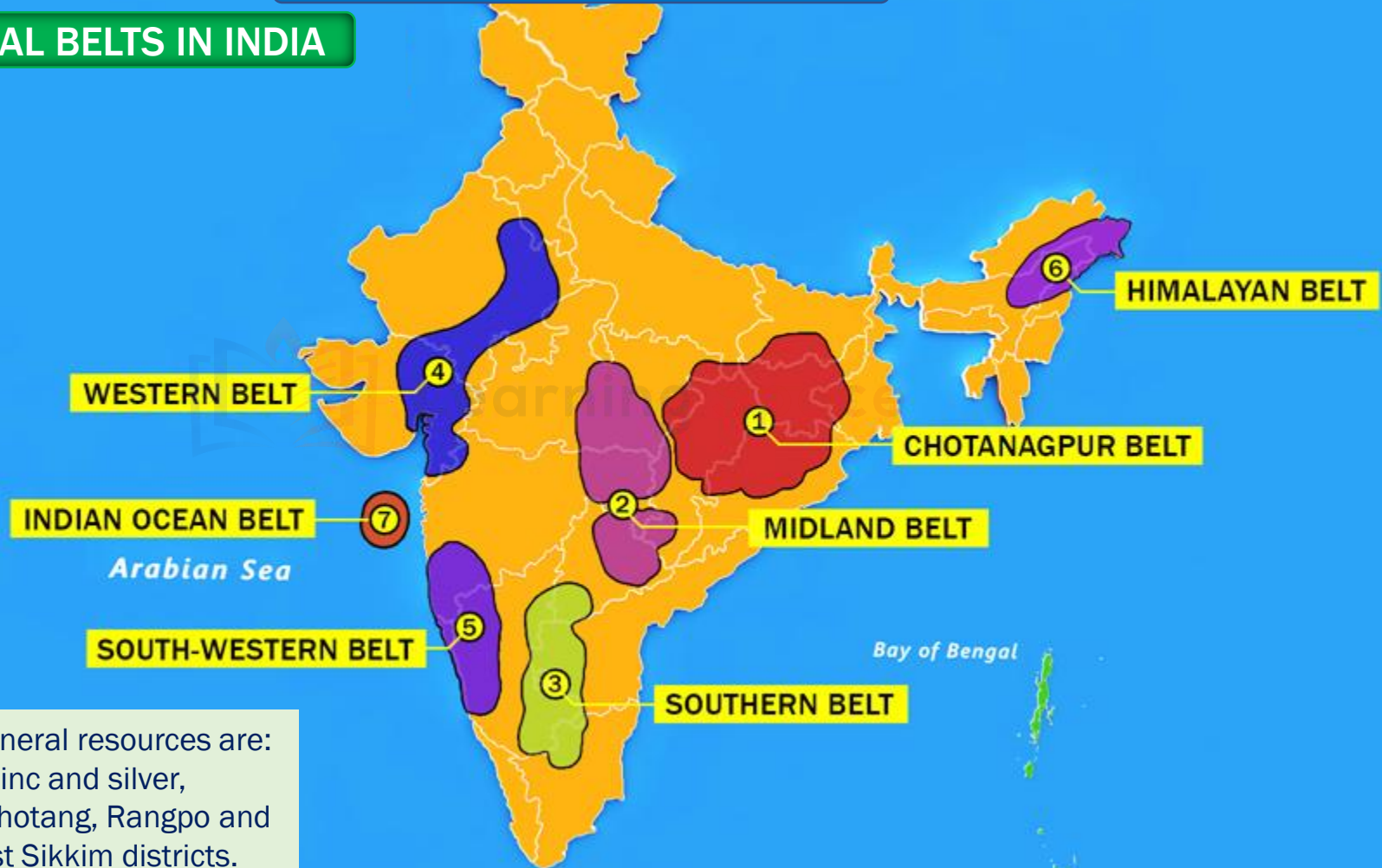
STATE BY STATE ... SIKKIM

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MAJOR CROPS



Top producer of large cardamom, contributing over 80% to India's total production.



The important mineral resources are:

- copper-lead-zinc and silver, reported in Bhotang, Rangpo and Dikchu in East Sikkim districts.

STATE BY STATE ... SIKKIM

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INFRASTRUCTURE ... POWER PLANTS



(TIBET)

NEPAL

Singshore bridge



BHUTAN

WEST B

- **Singshore Bridge** is highest bridge in Sikkim and the 2nd highest bridge in Asia.
- **Chicham Bridge** in Spiti Valley, Himachal Pradesh is Asia's highest bridge.



Pakyong Airport:

- First greenfield airport constructed in the Northeastern Region.
- 100th operational airport in India, and the only airport in the state of Sikkim



STATE BY STATE ... SIKKIM

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NATIONAL PARKS, WLS, BR

Khangchendzonga BR

Khangchendzonga NP

Shingba Rhododendron WLS

CHINA
(TIBET)

Fambong Lho WLS

Maenam WLS

NEPAL

BHUTAN

Kyongnosla Alpine WLS

Barsey Rhododendron WLS

Pangolakha WLS

WLS - WILDLIFE SANCTUARY

NP - NATIONAL PARK

BR - BIOSPHERE RESERVE

Khangchendzonga BR: 11th to enter UNESCO's World Network of Biosphere Reserves.

FACT: THERE ARE NO RAMSAR WETLANDS, TIGER AND ELEPHANT RESERVES IN SIKKIM.

**KHANGCHENDZONGA
MIXED HERITAGE SITE**

NEPAL

CHINA
(TIBET)

BHUTAN

WEST BEN

Sacred Himalayan Landscape:

- Part of the initiation of the World Wildlife Federation (WWF).
- It taps into the spiritual beliefs and conservation ethics of local communities to restore essential habitats and protect endangered species such as the snow leopard.

Khangchendzonga National Park has been inscribed as India's first "Mixed World Heritage Site"

RUMTEK MONASTERY



- Also called the Dharmachakra Centre.
- Seat of Gyalwa Karmapa.
- Home to the monks community, the place where they perform the sacred rituals and practices of the Karma Kagyu lineage.

THANKA PAINTINGS



- Depict life sketches of gods and goddesses in different forms.
- Occupy a predominant place in monasteries and homes.
- Materials used are stone colors and vegetable dyes together with gold dust and gold thread used for the tapestry.

BUMCHU FESTIVAL



- Celebrated at the Tashiding Monastery.
- It is said that by taking a drop of the Bumchu water, enlightenment is achieved and all of the evil spirits and distress are removed.

STATE BY STATE ... SIKKIM

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TRIBES

LEPCHA



- Mostly agriculturists and known for their unique weaving and basketry skills.
- Popular festival: Tendong Lho Rum Faat
- Recently, Lepcha community resents Home ministry's notification to lift an 18-year-old ban on Mt. Kangchenjunga by including it in the "open area".

BHUTIA



- Followers of Vajrayana Buddhism, mainly the Nyingma and Kagyu schools.
- Main festivals: Losar and Losoong.
- Recognized as Scheduled Tribes in Sikkim, West Bengal and Tripura.

NEPALI



- Constitute 70% of the total population of Sikkim.
- Introduced terrace farming in the state.
- Cardamom is an important cash crop that was cultivated by the Nepalese.

Proposal for reservation of seats for Limboo and Tamang communities in Sikkim Legislative Assembly is under consideration.

SMALL WOODBROWN BUTTERFLY



- After 120 years, researchers have rediscovered it in Khangchendzonga National Park.
- Scientifically known as *Lethe nicetella*.
- Endemic to Eastern Himalayas.

RED PANDA



- Found in Sikkim, western Arunachal Pradesh, Darjeeling (West Bengal) and parts of Meghalaya.
- Closely associated with Montane forests with dense bamboo-thicket
- Poached for its meat, for use in medicines, and as a pet.
- IUCN Status: Endangered

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IN RECENT NEWS

GLACIAL LAKES OUTBURST FLOODS
(GLOFs)

- Floods caused due to outburst of glacial lakes known as **Glacial Lakes Outburst Floods (GLOFs)**.
- South Lhonak lake is one of the fast growing lakes out of 14 potentially dangerous lakes susceptible to GLOFs in the Sikkim Himalaya region.

REAL-TIME LANDSLIDE WARNING
SYSTEM

- Set up in the Sikkim-Darjeeling belt of north-eastern Himalayas (earlier installed a landslide warning system in Kerala's Munnar district).
- Geological Survey of India is the “nodal agency” for the Indian government for landslide data repository and landslide studies.

ONE FAMILY – ONE JOB



- First state in the country to carry out such an exclusive programme.
- Scheme envisions employment to a member of every family which does not have a government job.
- Under this scheme, all loan debts in the farming and agriculture sector would be revoked.

MITH/MIT OR MITINI RELATIONSHIP



- Government of Sikkim gave formal approval to a traditional way of preserving trees by encouraging people to forge a relationship of brotherhood or sisterhood with trees (practice locally known as Mith/Mit or Mitini).
- Adopting a tree as his/her own child is called as an 'Adopted tree' and preserving a tree in remembrance of a departed relative is called as a 'Smriti tree'.

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SINCERE THANKS
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